2026

3rd Edition

AEASA

NEWSLETTER









SPECIAL FEATURE

63rd AEASA Conference

Balancing Geopolitics, Markets, and Food Security

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EDITOR'S NOTE



Maremo Mphahlele

WELCOME TO THE THIRD 2026 EDITION OF THE AEASA NEWSLETTER

This edition celebrates the contribution of agricultural economists to research, policy development and the strengthening of agricultural value chains. The issue reflects challenges facing agricultural economics scholarship in South Africa, particularly predatory publishing, declining research quality, and the pressure to publish. It emphasises the importance of ethical research practices, credible journals, peer collaboration, and responsible use of artificial intelligence in strengthening the discipline.

A key highlight of this edition is the 63rd AEASA Conference, which brought together researchers, practitioners and stakeholders to exchange ideas on agricultural development, international trade, investment and transformation. This edition also celebrates excellence within the agricultural economics profession through the recognition of outstanding students, postgraduate research, published scholarship, posters and contributed papers presented at the conference.

Beyond the conference, we recognise Dr Chiedza Tsvakirai's appointment to represent Southern Africa on the executive board of the African Association of Agricultural Economists for the 2026–2029 term. Furthermore, Dr Troskie was recognised as an AAAE Fellow in acknowledgement of his longstanding service to the association's executive committee.

We also reflect on the 2026 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences and the relevance of understanding household behaviour, expectations and economic decision-making when analysing macroeconomic stability and its implications for agricultural markets, investment and finance.

As we share these developments, we are reminded that the value of agricultural economics lies not only in producing research, but also in ensuring that evidence informs decisions, strengthens institutions and contributes to meaningful improvements in agricultural livelihoods.

Thank you to all contributors and readers for supporting the continued growth of our professional community. We hope this edition informs, inspires and encourages further engagement in advancing agricultural economics in South Africa and across the continent.

Enjoy the read!

Maremo Mphahlele

Newsletter editor

Reflections on Agricultural Economics scholarship in South Africa



Prof Eric Mungatana, Prof Nick Vink, Prof André Jooste and Prof Johann Kirsten
Department of Agricultural Economics, Stellenbosch University

Background

The scourge of predatory publishing hit the academic world with full force about a decade into the new millennium (e.g. Alt, 2026). Contrary to popular opinion, they are no longer the scourge of old, not because they are not still a problem, but mainly because the focus has shifted somewhat. In the first place, predatory publishers are far more sophisticated than before: their websites are more professional, journal titles are better (it was easy to guess that the Journal of Basic and Applied Science or similar titles such as the International Research Journal of Basic and Applied Sciences might actually be predatory), they at least pretend to follow core publication ethics, and so forth.

Secondly, what predatory publishers have always had going for them was a good business model: a) keep the journal electronic only so it costs almost nothing to produce; b) charge authors to have their work published (Article Processing Charges or APCs could reach levels as high as $5000 per paper); c) offer a speedy review process by lowering quality standards; and d) accept just about all submissions. These tactics allowed publishers to offer open access to all their authors and readers. This was so successful a model that mainstream publishers started to emulate them. This was done by introducing some or all of these practices in their own journals, or by simply purchasing or partnering with journal titles that had formerly been recognised as predatory.

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The result has been the rise of what has been called a 'gray zone' of publication (Alvarado-de la Barrera et al., 2024). These are mostly weak journals who try to push the boundaries of acceptability, often by following strategies that combine legitimate with predatory practices, such as optimising APCs and expedited peer-review or journal acceptance rates. After all, a high APC would possibly make scholars think their peer review processes were acceptable. All these changes have made it much more difficult to identify weak journals, especially when they slip through the cracks and get listed erroneously on Scopus or Web of Science, or even our own DHET lists, and have respectable publication metrics. Yet not all articles in the 'gray zone' are weak, and not all journals trying to fool gullible scholars. The rejection rates of top journals have grown smaller (our own Agrekon, after all, has a rejection rate of 94%), and APCs in the very top journals can be prohibitive. The journal Nature, for example, charges authors of accepted papers a princely sum of $12 850, not a sum that many can afford, and a distinct disincentive for scholars from the global south. Little wonder that the number of authors per paper has increased so rapidly!

To be distinguished from the 'grey literature', which consists of research, reports, and other documents produced by organizations outside of commercial or academic publishing channels and includes government documents, working papers, conference proceedings, etc. These are mostly not peer-reviewed, but are useful sources of data, policy positions, and so forth.

What are the Impacts

It is well established that the number of scholarly articles published annually has exploded over time, and especially since the early 1990s when the internet became more widely available (see, for example, Curcic, 2023). As the number of researchers does not seem to have increased by much, the time spent by researchers on publications must have increased considerably (e.g. Hanson, et al., 2024). While this may seem like a good thing, the data show that most of the increase has come from publishers who are generally referred to as "paper mills". As noted, these are not always classifiable as predatory. What they have in common is practices which undermine confidence in the quality of articles (Hanson, et al., 2024). The situation in South Africa is a little different. Here, the rapid increase in student numbers in the democratic era has resulted in an increase in academic positions, hence increased competition for these positions. At the same time, with an economy that has stagnated for more than a decade, new graduates are desperate for permanent positions with a regular income, and academia has become a more sought-after prospect than in times of economic prosperity. Then those who do land up in research positions have come under increased pressure to "publish or perish". In the process, the temptation to seek out journals which don't bother too much with peer-review, and which don't make you wait too long until your article is accepted increases. This is unfortunately also the case with articles in our discipline in South Africa, where the explosion in the number of weaker journals has also supplied the avenue for the publication of weaker work.

The impact of the erosion in trust comes at two levels. For society as a whole it represents a waste of resources that could best be deployed elsewhere. APCs are only the tip of the iceberg – the opportunity costs could be greater. Secondly, they undermine many academic processes, such as researcher evaluations for grants, promotion and so on, and they can even undermine institutional reputations. Thirdly, publications such as systematic reviews and meta-analyses are useful tools in science. If the data on which these are based is corrupted, they are less useful, to put it mildly. Fourthly, good science depends on ease of access to new knowledge, but this phenomenon undermines the credibility of Open Access as the gold standard of publishing.

The consequences for individual researchers can be even more drastic. Science depends on

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trust, and a tainted reputation is just about the last thing any scientist wants. That game certainly is not worth the candle as a reputation lost is not easily regained. One citation of a predatory journals in an article, monograph or thesis/ dissertation can be considered a mistake. More than one means the authors are wittingly or unwittingly aiding and abetting this practice and should be (politely) asked not to do it again. But our Association can only be successful if we don't give prizes to, or publish articles, that contain citations to work published in predatory Journals. Our Association should also make authors of these works who are members of AEASA aware of the pitfalls that come with publishing in them and discourage them from doing so.

What should a good researcher do?

There is a very long answer to this question, and fortunately also a very short answer. The former starts with looking through the many updated variants of the original Beall's List, thoroughly investigating the publisher's and journal's websites, studying journal metrics, and on and on. The short answer is to go to the website Think, Check, **Submit (https://thinkchecksubmit.org/journals/)** and work through their checklist. Interestingly, the checklist starts with asking whether you or your colleagues, peers and seniors know the journal.

Publishing in mainstream journals is an important part of the solution. However, the quality and legitimacy of new knowledge is ultimately established by a community of peers who subject it to critical scrutiny, challenge its claims, and validate its contributions. This reality makes the active support of colleagues for our journals, whether as reviewers, editors, or contributors, indispensable to the advancement of our discipline. This sets you up to do what you already know you should do, which is to talk to your peers, and keep talking to them. After all, we are a community of scholars who meet at least once a year, and we should recognise that these as well as focussed workshops and writing retreats, etc. constitute the all-important networking opportunities which characterise all good scholarship. If we do this properly, we will have the added benefit of seeing Agrekon rise to even greater heights. Research is no longer a lonely pursuit – most good research comes from vigorous teamwork, and it is always a good idea to build teams and to use their collective wisdom. Of course we will always have to beware of those who will use this advice to build teams of people who are intent on gaming the publications system, but we trust that in our discipline these will be few and far between. That means exposing the rotten apples who are already there and helping them to change their ways.

Finally, we come to artificial intelligence. Here again there is a long and a short answer. The long answer will entail ways of establishing and following ethical practice in the use of AI. For example, if a journal or the NRF asks you to review an article or an application for rating or research funding, AI should only help you to write a good review, and you should disclose the fact that you have used it. There's lots more, but the short answer is to ask someone younger than you to help to keep you on the straight and narrow path!

The editors of Agrekon:

Prof Nick Vink
(2002-2009)

Prof Johann Kirsten
(2015-2025)

Prof André Jooste
(2010 – 2015)

Prof Eric Mungatana
(2026 - Present)

As Marked, Against All Odds: A Reflection on the 63rd AEASA Conference



Ms Lerato Vinolia Malebati



Ms Mlangeni Ayanda Prosperity

The words "as marked, against all odds", shared by the Local Organising Committee (LOC) Chairperson, **Dr Lesetja Jacob Ledwaba**, during the closing celebrations, perfectly captured the spirit of the 63rd Annual Conference of the Agricultural Economics Association of South Africa (AEASA). Held from 29 September to 1 October 2026 at Legend Golf & Safari Resort in Mokopane, Limpopo, the conference was much more than an academic gathering. It was a celebration of knowledge, professional growth, research excellence, collaboration, resilience and the future of agricultural economics in South Africa. Hosted by the University of Limpopo, University of Venda and the Limpopo Department of Agriculture and Rural Development, the conference was held under the theme: "Geopolitics in Agriculture: Striking a Balance Between Policy, Markets, Food Security and Shared Prosperity."

The theme created an important platform for reflecting on how agricultural economists can respond to changing global trade relationships, geopolitical tensions, climate change, technological transformation, market disruptions, food-security concerns and the need for inclusive economic development.

The conference opened with a welcome and messages from the University of Limpopo leadership, the Dean of the Faculty of Science and Agriculture, **Prof Leseilane Mampuru,** who delivered the University's opening address on behalf of the Vice-Chancellor and Principal, **Ms Mpho Abigail Mashamba,** Head of Department in the Limpopo Department of Agriculture and Rural Development, and **Prof Jan Johannes Hlongwane,** President of AEASA. Their messages immediately placed the conference within the realities facing agriculture, highlighting the need to respond to geopolitical tensions, climate change, market disruptions, food-security concerns and technological transformation.

The opening set the tone for a conference that sought not only to understand these challenges but also to consider how agricultural economists can contribute to practical and sustainable solutions.

One of the highlights of the first day was the Agriculture and Agroprocessing Masterplan - Value Chain Round Tables (VCRTs) workshop, themed "Unlocking Shared Prosperity: Value Chain Round Tables as Drivers of Growth,

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Competitiveness, and Investments in South African Agriculture." Contributions from stakeholders including the National Agricultural Marketing Council, the Agriculture and Agro-processing Master Plan, Fruit South Africa, the olive industry and provincial agriculture demonstrated the importance of bringing different actors together to understand the agricultural value chain as a connected system.

The plenary session on global trade, market access and strategic partnerships, featuring **Trudi Hartzenberg and Dr Lucius Phaleng,** further broadened the conversation. The discussions reinforced that South African agriculture cannot be understood in isolation from international developments, as global markets, trade relationships and geopolitical shifts increasingly influence domestic agricultural outcomes. Even navigating the conference programme became a small exercise in optimization, moving between rooms, checking session times and trying not to arrive late. Perhaps this was the conference's unofficial practical lesson in agricultural economics: minimise walking distance subject to the constraint of being on time!

The second day featured the **Simon Brand Memorial Address, delivered by Prof Scott D. Rozelle, Helen F. Farnsworth Professor of International Agricultural Policy at Stanford University.** Although he was unable to attend the conference in person due to a hand injury and a medical appointment, his humour, warmth and engaging style came through strongly in his presentation. His address, "China's Agricultural Development and Policies: Are There Lessons for Africa and Other Developing Countries?", offered valuable reflections on South Africa's own agricultural transformation journey. One of the key messages was both simple and thought provoking: "It is possible, Mzansi, but it is not a miracle." China's agricultural transformation was not achieved overnight; it was supported by sustained investment, strong institutions, skills development, innovation and effective implementation. This raises an important question for South Africa: are our transformation and SDG commitments becoming visible in actual agricultural activities, productivity, livelihoods and investment, or are we sometimes placing too much emphasis on plans and timelines? The discussion also reinforced the importance of anticipating challenges rather than waiting for them to become crises.

> *"It is possible, Mzansi, but it is not a miracle."* Prof Scott D. Rozelle – Simon Brand Memorial Address

Against All Odds: The Message We Take Forward

The 63rd AEASA Conference demonstrated that agricultural economists have an important role in shaping South Africa's agricultural future. Despite rainy conditions, the conference continued to deliver meaningful discussions, research recognition, networking and memorable moments. More importantly, it reminded us that research should not end with publication. It should inform decisions, anticipate challenges, strengthen value chains and contribute to tangible transformation.

Agriculture itself operates against odds everyday climate uncertainty, rising costs, geopolitical tensions, financing constraints and market volatility. Yet farmers continue producing, businesses continue investing and researchers continue searching for solutions. Perhaps that is why "as marked, against all odds" feels so appropriate. We may work with models on computers, but the consequences of our work are experienced in farms, markets, households and communities. The challenge now is to ensure that our knowledge does not remain on paper but becomes part of the change agriculture needs.



Ms Lerato Vinolia Malebati - PhD Student in Agricultural Economics | Former Part-Time Lecturer, University of Limpopo | AEASA 2026 Best Poster – 1st Position



Ms Mlangeni Ayanda Prosperity - MSc Student in Agricultural Economics, University of Limpopo

There's a New Representative for Southern Africa in the African Association of Agricultural Economists' Leadership

Dr Chiedza Tsvakirai has been appointed to represent Southern Africa on the executive committee of the African Association of Agricultural Economists (AAAE) for the 2026–2029 term. This appointment strengthens the role of the Agricultural Economics Association of South Africa (AEASA) in fostering regional collaboration, academic engagement, and the visibility of Southern African agricultural economists within the broader African community.



Dr Chiedza Tsvakirai

What is the AAAE, and how does it relate to AEASA?

The African Association of Agricultural Economists (AAAE) is a professional association dedicated to promoting agricultural economics research, education, and professional engagement across the continent. Through its conferences, publications, and networking opportunities, the AAAE provides a vital platform for agricultural economists to share research, exchange ideas, and contribute to solving Africa's agricultural and food system challenges.

This mission aligns closely with that of AEASA, which serves as a national professional association promoting agricultural economics research, education, and professional development in South Africa. While AEASA focuses on the national landscape, the AAAE provides a continental platform for collaboration and knowledge exchange. The two associations have complementary objectives, with AEASA members actively contributing to the broader African agricultural economics community through AAAE conferences, research networks, and scholarly activities.

A Leader with a Wealth of Experience

Dr Tsvakirai has been a member of AEASA since 2012 and a member of AAAE since 2016. She is an NRF rated researcher and has built an academic and research career spanning several South African universities and research institutions. Her professional journey has included work with the Agricultural Research Council, the University of Pretoria, the University of South Africa (UNISA),

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North-West University, the University of Mpumalanga and the University of Fort Hare. She continues to maintain research collaborations across institutions and currently holds a Senior Lecturer appointment at the University of Namibia, alongside an adjunct professorial appointment at the University of Arkansas in the United States. Her experience across institutions and national contexts provides a valuable foundation for strengthening academic networks and fostering collaboration among agricultural economists in Southern Africa and beyond.

A Legacy of Service

Chiedza's appointment was announced during the AAAE Conference held in Nairobi, Kenya, from 22 to 25 September. She joins the AAAE executive leadership following the service of previous Southern African representatives, Prof. Thinah Moyo (Namibia University of Science and Technology) and Dr Dirk Troskie (Western Cape Department of Agriculture). At this meeting, Dr Troskie was recognised as an AAAE Fellow in acknowledgement of his longstanding service to the association's executive committee.



Dr Dirk Troskie
Western Cape Department of Agriculture



Prof Thinah Moyo
Namibia University of Science and Technology

Looking ahead: Strengthening Southern Africa's Voice

In her new role, Dr Tsvakirai aims to strengthen engagement between AEASA and the AAAE, which entails encouraging the growth of AEASA membership, the readership and reach of Agrekon, and greater scholarly contributions from agricultural economists across Southern Africa. Importantly, she aims to promote stronger academic engagement within the region and increase the participation of Southern African researchers and professionals in AAAE conferences, research networks and other activities. She looks forward to working with other regional representatives to create opportunities for cross-regional research collaboration, funding for early career researchers and strengthen the connection between evidence and policy.

63RD AEASA CONFERENCE



Dr Simphiwe Ngqangweni | *Chief Executive Officer, NAMC*



Dr Victor Tindisa
Senior Manager: MERC, NAMC



Prof André Jooste
Chairperson of the Council, NAMC



Dr Hilda Lefophane
Senior Lecturer, UL



Ms Werna Oberholzer
CCA & Sustainability, Tiger Brands



Dr Lindikhaya Myeki
Senior Lecturer, NMU



Dr. Melissa van der Merwe
Senior Lecturer, Stellenbosch University



Dr Solly Molepo
Manager: Trade Research, NAMC



Mr Bonani Nyhodo
Senior Manager: ARMD, NAMC



Prof Jan Hlongwane
President, AEASA (Professor, UL)



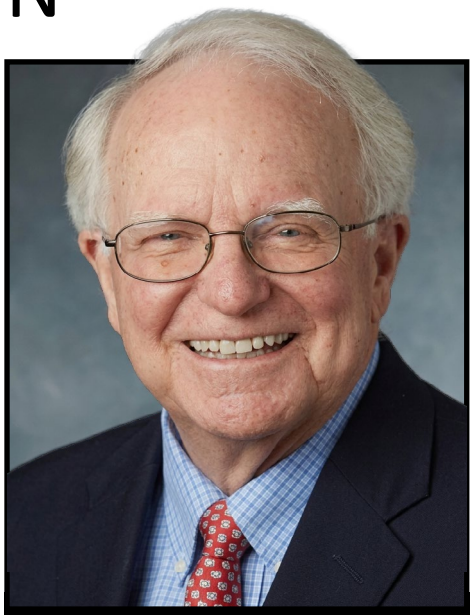
Mr Thabile Nkunjane
Senior Economist: Trade Research, NAMC



Ms Sibongile Makwarela
Acting Director, Limpopo (DARD)

2026 NOBEL PRIZE IN ECONOMICS: RECOGNISING THE MICROECONOMIC FOUNDATIONS OF MACROECONOMIC STABILISATION

Information: The 2026 Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel was awarded to Robert E. Hall of Stanford University and Michael Woodford of Columbia University for their work on the microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation. This year the Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences is for recognising the contributions of Professor Robert E. Hall of Stanford University and Professor Michael Woodford of Columbia University for their work on the microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation. The contributions highlighted by their research are on the importance of understanding household behaviour, expectations and economic decision-making when designing policies to promote economic stability.



Prof Robert E. Hall
Stanford University



Prof Michael Woodford
Columbia University

The award returns to one of the central questions in macroeconomics: how can policymakers stabilise an economy in the face of economic fluctuations? The work associated with these two distinguished Professors offers important insights into how individual decisions and expectations influence broader economic outcomes and how central banks can use monetary policy to respond to changing economic conditions.

Why this research contribution matters

Professor Robert E. Hall's 1978 influential contribution examined the relationship between household consumption and expected lifetime income. His work demonstrated that, under the permanent-income hypothesis and its associated assumptions, that says changes in consumption should be difficult to predict using information already available to households. This perspective strengthened the connection between microeconomic decision-making and aggregate consumption patterns.

Professor Michael Woodford's contribution to New Keynesian macroeconomics developed a framework for understanding monetary policy, particularly how interest-rate decisions, expectations and central bank communication influence economic activity. His work has helped shape modern thinking about how central banks formulate policy and communicate their intentions to households, firms and financial markets.

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Collaboratively, these contributions demonstrate why macroeconomic stabilisation cannot be understood solely through aggregate indicators. The decisions of individual households and firms, their expectations about the future, and their responses to policy interventions are central to explaining how an economy behaves.

Relevance of this work and recognition to Agricultural Economics

For all Agricultural Economists, this works offers several important lessons. Agricultural markets are closely connected to macroeconomic conditions through interest rates, inflation, exchange rates, credit availability and household purchasing power.

For example, changes in monetary policy can influence the cost of borrowing for farmers, agribusinesses and agricultural cooperatives. Higher interest rates may increase production and investment costs, while changes in household income expectations can affect demand for agricultural commodities and food products. These effects can extend across agricultural value chains, influencing production decisions, input purchases, investment and food affordability.

The research contribution is also relevant to agricultural finance in understanding how farmers form expectations about future income, prices and production costs can help researchers and financial institutions assess investment behaviour, credit demand and repayment capacity. Such insights are particularly important when developing financing frameworks for smallholder farmers, whose investment decisions may be shaped by climate risks, market uncertainty and limited access to financial services.

Furthermore, the relationship between monetary policy and expectations highlights the importance of credible policy communication. Predictable and transparent economic policies can help agricultural producers and agribusinesses make more informed decisions in an environment characterised by uncertainty.

A message for colleagues in Agricultural Economics

The significance of this recognition extends beyond monetary economics. It reminds us that agricultural research benefits from integrating microeconomic behaviour with macroeconomic policy analysis. Whether we are examining agricultural investment, food prices, household consumption, rural finance or the resilience of agricultural value chains, understanding how economic agents respond to incentives and expectations remains essential.

For Agricultural Economists, researchers, lecturers and postgraduate students, this is an opportunity to reflect on how modern macroeconomic theory can inform empirical research and policy recommendations in the agricultural sector. It also reinforces the value of interdisciplinary research that connects household and firm-level decisions with wider economic processes.

Further reading: The background article supplied for this update is available at [The Nobel Prize in Economics 2026 – M.A. S. Economics.]



Mr Kegaogetswe Baloyi

CELEBRATING EXCELLENCE IN AGRICULTURAL ECONOMICS



Recognising outstanding academic achievement and research excellence

The Agricultural Economics Association of South Africa (AEASA) 2026 Conference Gala Dinner celebrated academic achievement and research excellence across the agricultural economics discipline. The awards recognised emerging talent, postgraduate research, scholarly publications, poster presentations and contributed papers addressing important agricultural and economic issues.

Emerging talent recognised across seven universities

The Best Final-Year BSc Agricultural Economics Students Award, sponsored by AEASA, recognised students from seven universities:

STELLENBOSCH UNIVERSITY
Harding Aimee Sarah

UNIVERSITY OF LIMPOPO
Seloane Phetolo Pheladi

UNIVERSITY OF THE FREE STATE
Jansen van Rensburg Mianc ke

UNIVERSITY OF PRETORIA
Steyn Jurgen

UNIVERSITY OF FORT HARE
Mrwebi Nwabisa

UNIVERSITY OF MPUMALANGA
Xulu VS

NORTH-WEST UNIVERSITY, MAHIKENG CAMPUS
Matshidiso Twala



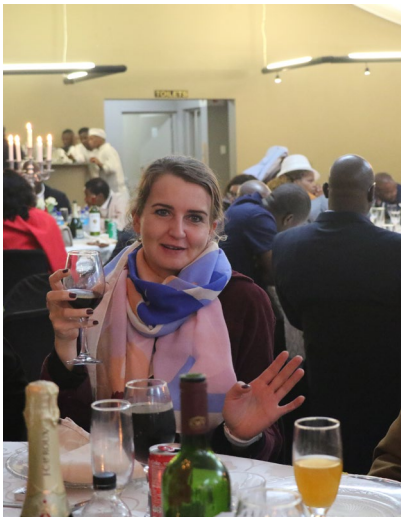






















Research Paper Awards

BEST MASTER'S DISSERTATION AWARD

Sponsored by the Oil and Protein Development Trust and the Oilseeds Advisory Committee

FIRST PRIZE

G Viljoen

Determinants of Maize Producers' Intentions to Adopt Price Risk Management Tools in the Free State, South Africa: An Extended Theory of Planned Behaviour Model Application.

SUPERVISORS

Dr Markus Monteiro, Prof. Yonas T. Bahta and Prof. Henry Jordaan.

SECOND PRIZE

K Schultz

An investigation into South Africa's agricultural trade opportunities and market access alignment within BRICS+.

SUPERVISORS

Prof. André Jooste and Prof. Rémi Stellian.



Recognition of Public Scholarship

THE BEST PUBLICATION IN A PROFESSIONAL JOURNAL OR BEST PUBLISHED BOOK AWARD

Sponsored by the Oil and Protein Development Trust and the Oilseeds Advisory Committee

FIRST PRIZE

M van den Berg, B Grove´, N Matthews and J Barnard

Farm-level water-energy-food nexus optimization using hybrid metaheuristic–mathematical programming.

JOURNAL
Energy Nexus

SECOND PRIZE

L Hayo, PT Jacobs and H Hasegawa

Cereal yield's effect on greenhouse gas emissions in South Africa: Examining the Environmental Kuznets Curve hypothesis.

JOURNAL
Energy Nexus



Poster awards

Sponsored by the Oil and Protein Development Trust and the Oilseeds Advisory Committee
The Best Poster Award, sponsored by the Oil and Protein Development Trust and the Oilseeds Advisory Committee, recognised research on agricultural value chains and food security.

FIRST PRIZE

LV Malebati, JJ Hlongwane, VM Mmbengwa, MA Nkoana and BB Dlamini

A Systematic Review and Structural Design of the Maize Value Chain in South Africa: Market and Transformation Implications.

FIRST PRIZE

P Mdwebi, M Mamabolo, C Machethe, S Laurie and M Mashitoa

The Role of Agro-Processing in Translating Sweet Potato Varieties into Food Security Gains: Lessons from African Countries.

Best Contributed Paper

Sponsored by the Protein Research Foundation, the Best Contributed Paper Award recognised three research contributions.

FIRST PRIZE

K Kalimbwe, NM Abdullahi, JN Ng'ombe and S Mbai

Trading Below the Frontier: Export Efficiency and Potential in Namibia's Live Goat Trade Using a Stochastic Frontier Gravity Model.

SECOND PRIZE

K Schultz, A Jooste and R Stellian

An investigation into South Africa's agricultural trade opportunities and market access alignment within BRICS+.

THIRD PRIZE

B Dube, J Kau, NS Molepo, M Lungwana and A Msezeni

Assessing agricultural employment adjustment under structural transformation in the Republic of South Africa.

Articles featured in the current issue of the journal can be accessed in Agrekon, Volume 65, Issue 2 (2026)

62nd AEASA Presidential Address 2025

Search for intellectual diversity to unmask policy denialism
Sifiso Mboneni Ntombela

The 2025 FR Tomlinson Commemorative Lecture

Seven decades since Tomlinson: the evolution of agricultural and rural development policy in South Africa
Simphiwe Ngqangweni

Special Section

Land reform beyond redistribution: Farm performance, tenure and gender in Southern Africa
Siphe Zantsi

What happens on land reform farms in South Africa? A field-based reality check
Ruth Hall & Thembela Kepe

The inverse relationship revisited: returns to farm size and efficiency in the PLAS project
Euan Chew, Siphe Zantsi & Beatrice Conradie

General Research Articles

Customary land ownership, decision making and inheritance in Eastern Zambia: do patrilineality and matrilineality matter?
Bridget Bwalya

The effect of early weaning of Bonsmara bull calves on their profitability under feedlot conditions
Kgotso Patrick Matli, Thobela Louis Tyasi & Pieter Fourie

Measurement error in cassava variety identification: results from comparison of DNA fingerprinting, farmer-reported data, and a phenotypic protocol for cassava varietal identification in Malawi
John Ilukor, James Stevenson, Talip Kilic, Heather Moylan, Frédéric Kosmowski & Josh Brubaker

Impact of maize input subsidies on household food security in north eastern Zimbabwe: a propensity score matching approach

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Freddy Ruzhani & Abbyssinia Mushunje

The impact of small-scale irrigation on household welfare: evidence from Ethiopia
Teshome Hailemeskel Abebe, Alemayehu Temesgen Befikadu & Temesgen Mulugeta Gugsa

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Obituary

In memoriam: Johann (Laupie) Laubscher, 1945–2026
Nick Vink & Theo Kleynhans

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The Agricultural Economics Association of South Africa